

FIGURE 3.7 Shinkichi Tajiri, *The Berlin Wall, 1981* (detail). (Shinkichi Tajiri Estate)

The same year, another casting of the *Friendship Knot* was given a permanent placement in the United States. Standing over twenty feet tall, the work was fabricated and shipped from the Netherlands to Tajiri's hometown of Los Angeles. This *Friendship Knot* was placed in Little Tokyo on Weller Court, outside the previous home of the Japanese American National Museum. In a rare occurrence, Tajiri returned briefly to America for the dedication ceremony. Family members from Europe and the United States joined Tajiri, as did such luminaries as Los Angeles mayor Tom Bradley and actor George Takei, himself a former resident of the internment camps. As a new landmark of the Japanese American section of the city, the *Friendship*